PPROG

Threads and Processes

Def. 1. ***Process:*** *A program executing inside an OS (operating-system). Processes share cpu but have their own memory space.*

Def. 2. *The* ***context*** *of a process is the set of utilities it uses and or operates on. That is:*

- ***Hardware context:*** *Instruction counter, Registers, Execution State, Flags ...*
- ***Memory context:*** *Virtual Memory, Heap-Space, Stack ...*
- ***OS-level context:*** *Process ID, open files ...*

The **Process Lifecycle** is managed by the OS and can be in one of the following states:

- **NEW / CREATED:** The process is being created and loaded from disk into memory.
- **READY:** The process is in main memory waiting to be assigned to the CPU by the scheduler.
- **RUNNING:** The process is actively executing instructions on the CPU.
- **BLOCKED / WAITING:** The process cannot continue executing and is waiting for an event (like I/O access) to complete.
- **TERMINATED:** The process has finished execution and its resources are reclaimed.

Def. 3. ***Context Switch:*** *The process of saving the context of a process and loading the context of another process.*

Def. 4. ***Process Control Block (PCB):*** *A table-entry storing relevant process information such as Program counter, Registers, Adress Space, Open files ...*

Parallelism

Def. 5. ***Parallelism*** *is when multiple processes execute simultaneously on diffrent CPU-Cores.*

Def. 6. ***Concurrency*** *is when multiple processes execute interleaved on a single CPU-Core.*

Rem. 7.

$$\textit{Parallelism} \implies \textit{Concurrency}$$
$$\textit{Concurrency} \not\Longrightarrow \textit{Parallelism}$$

Multithreading

Def. 8. *A thread is an independent sequence of exection running in the same OS-process.*

Rem. 9. *While processes can only communicate through main-memory and have diffrent memory spaces, threads share the same adress space. This leads to faster and more efficient context-switches as adressspace and PCB loading is not necessary.*

There are diffrent levels of threads:

- **User-Level Threads:** Threads managed by the application using a thread library, ex. Java-Threads managed by JVM
- **Kernel-Level Threads:** Threads managed by to OS, which can schedule them on diffrent cores.
- **CPU-Level Threads:** Threads managed by the CPU, which can schedule them on the physical cores.

There are two ways to create a thread in java.

Code Example 10

```
class MyThread extends Thread { ...
    public void run() {
        ...
    }
}
MyThread thread = new MyThread();
thread.start(); // calls MyThread.run()
```

or using a runnable, which is recomended to do:

Code Example 11

```
class MyRunnable implements Runnable { ...
    public void run() {
        ...
    }
}
MyRunnable runnable = new MyRunnable();
Thread thread = new Thread(runnable);
thread.start(); // calls MyRunnable.run()
```

In its lifecylce a thread can have the follwoing states:

- **NEW:** The thread has been created but not yet started.
- **RUNNABLE:** The thread is ready to run and waiting for the OS to schedule it.
- **RUNNING:** The thread is currently executing.
- **BLOCKED:** The thread is waiting for access to I/O devices
- **WAITING:** The thread is waiting to be notified
- **TERMINATED:** The thread has finished its execution

Rem. 12. *Every Thread has an* ***ID, Name, Priority and State*** *which might be usfull for certain tasks.*

To wait for a thread to finish, we can use the .join() method on the thread we want to wait on. This lets the main-thread sleep until the joined thread terminates and wakes it up again.

Code Example 13

```
Thread t = new MyThread();
t.start(); //start t
t.join(); //sleep until t is finished
continueWork(); // this is only called after t
        finishes
```

Rem. 14. *.join() creates overhead, for small thread-exection-time this is ineffiecient.*

Imp. 15. *If a worker-thread throws an exception the main-thread* ***will be woken up, but it will not know of the error****. We have to set an* ***UncaughtExeptionHandler using a try-catch block*** *when joining threads. For threads that run indefinetly we use a* ***timer task*** *that interupts threads.*

Code Example 16

```
MyTimerThread extends Thread {
    run(Thread thread, int time) {
        timer.sleep(time);
        thread.interupt();
    }
}

Thread t = new MyThread();
Thread timer = new MyTimerThread();
t.start();
timer.start(t, 1000);
try {
    t.join();
} catch (UncaughtExeptionHandler) {
    System.out.println("Error in thread t");
}
continueWork();
```

Synchronization

Def. 17. ***Critical Section:*** *Codeblocks that might lead to bad interleavings.*

Def. 18. ***Thread Safety:*** *Nothing bad happeing in all possible interleavings.*

Def. 19. ***Thread Liveness:*** *Something good happening eventually.*

Locks and Synchronized

Every Java-Object has an **intrinsic lock** or lock monitor. These locks are **unique** and can be optaind by threads which allows us to lock a certain codeblock.

Code Example 20

```
synchronized(lockObject) {
    i++;
}
```

Rem. 21. *Synchronized can also be used as a keyword on a method to sync. the whole method.*

Rem. 22. *By default synchronized uses "this" as the lock-object.*

Rem. 23. *Java-Locks are reentrant meaning they can be locked multiple times by the same Thread recursively (It will then have to release the look as many times as it aquired it).*

Atomic integers have builtin synchronization, for example for incrementing/decrementing.

Code Example 24

```
AtomicInteger counter = new AtomicInteger(0);
counter.incrementAndGet();
```

Wait, notify, notifyAll

We can use wait() on a lock-object to tell the current thread to sleep until further notice if the lock is not available. This allows use to save ressources.

Code Example 25

```
synchronized(lockObject) {
    while(!condition) {
        lockObject.wait();
    }
    // do work
}
```

Imp. 26. *Always wait inside a while loop, as this ensures checking the condition after beeing notified.*

To wake one arbitrary or all waiting threads we can use notify() or notifyAll() on the lock-object.

Code Example 27

```
synchronized(lockObject) {
    while (!condition) {
        lockObject.wait();
    }
    //do work
    notifyAll();
}
```

Lock API

Instead of using built-in synchronized blocks we can also use locks from the java.util.concurrent.locks package.

Code Example 28

```
private Lock lock = new ReentrantLock();
...
void doWork(int x) {
    lock.lock();
    try {
        ...
    } finally {
        lock.unlock();
    }
}
```

Imp. 29. *Always use a* ***try-finally block to ensure the lock is released*** *even if an error occures.*

Rem. 30. *Use lock.tryLock(100, TimeUnit.MILLISECONDS) to accuire the lock only for a given amount of time, avoiding deadlocks.*

Pros and Cons of synchronized vs Lock API:

Aspect	synchronized	Lock API
Handling	Auto (JVM)	Manual (lock/unlock)
Release	Automatic	Manual (finally!)
Scope	Block/Method	Flexible/Multi-method
Waiting	Infinite block	tryLock() avoids block
Interrupt	No	lockInterruptibly() ok
Flex.	Low	High
Comp.	Simple	Complex/Error-prone
Risk	Lower	Higher (forget unlock)
Usage	Simple sync	Advanced control